



Peter's Three Keys in Acts

ONE CHURCH. PROGRESSIVE OPENING.

In Acts, Peter is used by the Holy Spirit to open the door of the Gospel to everyone: first to Jews, then to Samaritans, and finally to Gentiles. This is not three churches—this is one Church expanding by God's plan.

1

JERUSALEM (ACTS 2)



THE JEWS FIRST

- ✓ Pentecost: The Holy Spirit comes on Jewish believers.
- ✓ Peter preaches to Jews in Jerusalem.
- ✓ ~3,000 are saved (Acts 2:41).
- ✓ The Church is born in Jerusalem.
- ✓ The foundation is laid.

KEY VERSE

Acts 2:5

"Jews from every nation under heaven were staying in Jerusalem."

2

SAMARIA (ACTS 8)



THE SAMARITANS NEXT

- ✓ Philip preaches Christ in Samaria.
- ✓ Many believe and are baptized.
- ✓ Peter and John come, lay hands on them.
- ✓ They receive the Holy Spirit.
- ✓ The Gospel crosses old hostility and division.

KEY VERSE

Acts 8:17

"Then they laid their hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit."

3

THE GENTILES (ACTS 10–11)



THE GENTILES FINALLY

- ✓ Peter preaches in the house of Cornelius.
- ✓ The Holy Spirit falls on Gentiles while Peter is still speaking.
- ✓ They speak in tongues and glorify God.
- ✓ Peter declares: "God shows no partiality" (Acts 10:34).
- ✓ The Church is now sent to the ends of the earth.

KEY VERSE

Acts 10:45

"The gift of the Holy Spirit was poured out even on the Gentiles."



KEY VERSES

Acts 2:38

"Peter replied, 'Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. And you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.'"

Acts 8:14–17

"When the apostles in Jerusalem heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent Peter and John to them, who went down and prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Spirit."

Acts 10:34–35, 45

"Then Peter opened his mouth and said: 'Truly I understand that God shows no partiality, but in every nation anyone who fears Him and does what is right is acceptable to Him.' ... The gift of the Holy Spirit was poured out even on the Gentiles."

Acts 11:18

"When they heard these things, they fell silent; and they glorified God, saying, 'Then to the Gentiles also God has granted repentance that leads to life.'"

THE PROGRESSION OF THE GOSPEL



JERUSALEM
The beginning
(Acts 2)



SAMARIA
A new frontier
(Acts 8)



**CORNELIUS' HOUSE
(GENTILES)**
A new people
(Acts 10)



THE NATIONS
The ultimate
commission
(Acts 1:8)

"You will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth." Acts 1:8

THREE OPENINGS, ONE CHURCH

ASPECT	JERUSALEM (ACTS 2)	SAMARIA (ACTS 8)	THE GENTILES (ACTS 10–11)
PEOPLE	Jews	Samaritans	Gentiles
OBSTACLE	None (Chosen people)	Ethnic hostility	Religious & cultural barrier
KEY FIGURE	Peter	Philip, then Peter & John	Peter
SIGN OF ACCEPTANCE	Baptism	Laying on of hands	Holy Spirit falls; tongues
DECLARATION	~3,000 saved	Many believe	"God shows no partiality" (Acts 10:34)
RESULT	Church begins	Church expands	Church goes to all nations
THEME	Foundation	Crossing barriers	Global mission



THE BIG PICTURE

Peter's three encounters show God's heart: salvation is not limited to one people group. The Gospel breaks down walls, creates one new humanity, and forms one Spirit-empowered Church for the glory of God.



TEACHER NOTE

Use this chart to help learners see the intentional progression in Acts. Emphasize unity in the Gospel and the equal value of all people in God's plan. Encourage discussion about barriers and how the Church is called to reflect God's inclusiveness today.



KEY TRUTHS

- God's plan always includes more people, not fewer.
- The same Gospel, the same Lord, the same Spirit, for all.
- Peter is not starting three churches—he is opening one Church to all.
- Hostility, ethnicity, and culture are no barrier to the Gospel.
- The mission moves outward by the Spirit's direction.



RELATED RESOURCES



Articles

See related RC1 articles online.



Visual Theology

View the Acts Progression Diagram.



Workbook

Complete the RC1 study guide.



Glossary

See: Jew, Samaritan, Gentile, Partiality, Mission.